

Asia Chart Alert

Global Markets Research

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Economics - Asia ex-Japan

China: Developers' contract sales value worsened further in July

The geographic K-shape might further delay necessary policy actions to clean up the mess in the property sector.

Research Analysts

Asia Economics

Jing Wang - NIHK

jing.wang@nomura.com

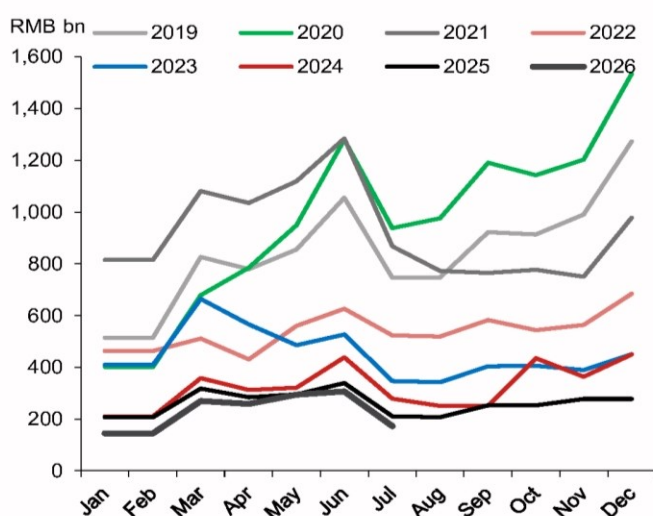
+852 2252 1011

Ting Lu - NIHK

ting.lu@nomura.com

+852 2252 1306

Fig. 1: New home contract sales by value: top 100 developers



- Contract sales value of the top 100 developers fell 18.3% y-o-y in July, worsening from a 9.6% decline in June, taking its year-to-date growth to -14.6% y-o-y in July (2025: -19.3%). Worsening sales value was likely due to rising downward pressure on home prices, especially in lower-tier cities, as top-tier cities showed clear signs of stabilization.
- On city-level data, growth in new home sales by floor space in 20 major cities rose to 3.2% y-o-y in July from -6.7% in June, thanks to a low base, while existing home sales volume growth in 18 major cities eased to 9.4% from 12.3%. Positive growth for the 20 cities was led by tier-1 cities, where sales growth rose to 16.6% y-o-y in July from -2.2% in June, with largely flat sales in tier-2 cities and a steeper decline in lower-tier cities.
- In the past, improving housing markets in top-tier cities might herald a broader recovery. However, this time might be different, as the AI boom siphons resources from legacy cities to smart cities, leading to a large divide. The mid-year Politburo meeting reiterated the need to stabilize housing markets, while the geographic K-shape has complicated policymaking and conventional policy measures are mostly exhausted.

Note: January and February data are presented as the same value as an average of these two months to smooth out LNY distortions.

Source: CRIC, Wind, Nomura Global Economics.

Appendix A-1

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